

# GNOME Desktop Cheat-Sheet

## GNOME desktop cheat-sheet

Stock Fedora 44 GNOME – no theming, no extensions beyond Fedora’s own **background-logo**. Reverted to defaults 2026-07-23. The old Windows-like rice (dash-to-panel, ArcMenu, Nord colors) is still in this repo behind the **gnome-nord** script if it’s ever wanted back; see [Recovery](#).

### Overview & apps

| Key                     | Action                                              |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Super</b>            | Activities overview (windows + workspaces + search) |
| Type after <b>Super</b> | Search apps/files, Enter to launch                  |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>A</b> | Application grid                                    |
| <b>Alt</b> + <b>F2</b>  | Run-command prompt                                  |
| Top-left hot corner     | Overview (mouse)                                    |

Favorites live in the dash on the left of the overview – right-click an app to pin. Add custom launch hotkeys in Settings > Keyboard > Custom Shortcuts.

### Windows

| Key                                             | Action                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Alt</b> + <b>Tab</b>                         | Switch between applications (grouped)        |
| <b>Alt</b> + <b>`</b>                           | Switch between windows of the current app    |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>Left/Right</b>                | Snap window to half screen (or drag to edge) |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>Up</b>                        | Maximize (or drag to top edge)               |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>Down</b>                      | Unmaximize / restore                         |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>H</b>                         | Minimize (“hide”)                            |
| <b>Alt</b> + <b>F4</b>                          | Close window                                 |
| <b>Alt</b> + <b>F7</b> / <b>Alt</b> + <b>F8</b> | Move / resize with the keyboard              |
| <b>F11</b>                                      | Fullscreen (app-dependent)                   |

### Workspaces

| Key                                                             | Action                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Super</b> + <b>Page Up</b> / <b>Page Down</b>                | Previous / next workspace             |
| <b>Super</b> + <b>Shift</b> + <b>Page Up</b> / <b>Page Down</b> | Move window to prev/next workspace    |
| <b>Ctrl</b> + <b>Alt</b> + <b>Left</b> / <b>Right</b>           | Previous / next workspace (alternate) |
| 3-finger touchpad swipe up                                      | Overview (all windows + workspaces)   |
| 4-finger touchpad swipe left/right                              | Switch workspace                      |

## Media / system

Volume, brightness, and media keys are handled natively by GNOME. System menu (network, bluetooth, battery, power off): top-right of the top bar. Lock screen: **Super + Shift + L**.

## Terminal apps

| Command | Action                                              |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| y       | yazi (in any terminal) – cds to wherever you exited |
| yazi    | yazi without the cd-on-exit behavior                |

## yazi keybinds

| Key              | Action                                                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| j / k or arrows  | Move down / up                                                              |
| h / l or arrows  | Parent dir / enter dir                                                      |
| H / L            | Back / forward in history                                                   |
| gg / G           | Top / bottom                                                                |
| gh               | Go home (~)                                                                 |
| gc               | Go to ~/.config                                                             |
| gd               | Go to ~/Downloads                                                           |
| <Space>          | Toggle selection on current file                                            |
| v / V            | Visual select mode / visual unset mode                                      |
| Ctrl+a / Ctrl+r  | Select all / invert selection                                               |
| y / x / p / P    | Yank (copy) / cut / paste / paste (overwrite)                               |
| d / D            | Trash / permanently delete                                                  |
| a                | Create file (end with / for a directory)                                    |
| r                | Rename                                                                      |
| o / Enter        | Open                                                                        |
| O / Shift+Enter  | Open interactively (pick app)                                               |
| .                | Toggle hidden files                                                         |
| / / ?            | Find next / previous                                                        |
| s / S            | Search by name (fd) / by content (ripgrep)                                  |
| f                | Filter files                                                                |
| tt               | New tab in current dir                                                      |
| 1-9              | Switch to tab N                                                             |
| [ / ]            | Previous / next tab                                                         |
| , then m/a/s/e/n | Sort by mtime / alphabetical / size / extension / natural (Shift = reverse) |
| w                | Task manager                                                                |
| ~ or F1          | Help (full keymap, searchable)                                              |
| q                | Quit                                                                        |

## GPU offload

Run any app on the NVIDIA dGPU instead of the AMD iGPU (GNOME always runs on AMD, since it drives the panel):

```
dgpu-run <command>
# e.g.
dgpu-run flatpak run org.prismlauncher.PrismLauncher
```

## Songs of Syx mods

The game runs its Windows build under Proton and does not see Steam Workshop subscriptions on its own, so the launcher's MODS tab shows up empty. `syx-mods-sync` symlinks every subscribed mod into the Proton prefix so the launcher lists them:

```
syx-mods-sync      # safe to re-run; prints what it linked
```

It runs automatically on game launch via Steam launch options (`syx-mods-sync; %command%`), so a new subscription is there next time you start. After subscribing you still have to tick the mod in the launcher's MODS tab, and mods must be enabled *before* starting a world.

Mods are linked, not copied, so Workshop updates apply with no action. Unsubscribing leaves a dead link that the next run cleans up. Hand-placed mod folders are real directories and are never touched.

## WiFi

GNOME's system menu (top-right of the taskbar) lists and connects to networks. The `wifi` script still works from any terminal:

```
wifi                # interactive picker
wifi "GC Public"    # connect straight to a named network
```

Saved networks reconnect without a prompt; new ones ask for a password. On a captive portal you'll associate but have no route out until you open any `http://` page and sign in.

## Recovery

The login screen is GDM, stock and unthemed (Fedora's default). SDDM and its Nord theme are still installed but inactive.

- **GNOME session won't start / crashes at login:** from a TTY, check `journalctl --user -b -u org.gnome.Shell@wayland.service` (or `journalctl -b -p err`). `Ctrl+Alt+F1` (or `F2`) back to the graphical screen.
- **Session hung:** `loginctl terminate-user cross` from a TTY force-kills it and drops back to the login screen.
- **Want the old Windows-like rice back:** `stow gtk && gnome-nord`, then log out/in. That re-enables dash-to-panel, ArcMenu and appindicator, restores the Nord colors and the per-window Alt-Tab, and re-applies the generated wallpaper. If ArcMenu is gone entirely (e.g. after a GNOME major upgrade breaks compatibility), reinstall the matching version from [extensions.gnome.org](https://extensions.gnome.org) (`gnome-extensions install <zip>`).
- **Desperate fallback session:** pick "GNOME Classic" at the login screen's session picker – ugly but always works. Normal logins should use plain "GNOME".